11.5.2 History of Boutiques

In the late 1990s, some European retail traders developed the idea of tailoring a shop towards a lifestyle theme, in what they called "concept stores" which specialized in cross-selling without using separate departments. One of the first concept stores was 10 Corso Como in Milan, Italy, founded in 1990, followed by Colette in Paris and Quartier 206 in Berlin. Several well-known American chains such as Tiffany and Co., Urban Outfitters, Dash, and The Gap, Australian chain Billabong and, though less common, Lord and Taylor, adapted to the concept store trend after 2000.

11.5.3 Merits of Boutiques

- Specialization in apparel selection and design.
- Own price advantage and expand clothing display scope.
- Improve clothing enterprises by quick response ability.
- Provide more promotion activities thereby meeting consumers personalized demands.

11.5.4 Demerits of Boutiques

- Lack of large variety in design
- Logistics and distribution problems
- Quality and label problems
- Cannot cater to needs of lower income

11.6 Designer Garments/ Wear

Designer garments are similar to boutique garments, but here a particular person with very good knowledge about fashion and skill in garment construction, foresees the upcoming fashion, sketches garment designs, sometimes develop fabrics suitable for a particular type of garment. A boutique might not have a designer, but usually a designer might have small set up to rather a unit, where he/she can develop patterns cut and stitch. A designer can foresees the upcoming fashion and design a range of garments for either one sex or both sexes of different age groups. Some designers work only for one person. Example- Famous celebrities, movie and the costume designers:

DO YOU KNOW?

When boutique was first started?

As a retailing concept, the boutique is associated with a distinct identity that reflects the taste of the designer or owner; small-scale production with rapid turnover of merchandise; fashion novelty and experimentation; innovative displays and interiors; and an informality among owner, salespeople, and clientele. Although the boutique phenomenon of the 1960s played itself out by the mid-1970s, boutiques remain a vital part of the commercial world of fashion- whether as an individual enterprise or incorporated into a larger setting, such as a department store.



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